



Notification Waiver Determination

Blackstone – Flow Control Holdings

Acquisition	Velocity I Purchaser, Inc., an affiliate of various funds advised and/or managed by affiliates of Blackstone Inc., (Purchaser) applied for a notification waiver in respect of its proposed acquisition of 100% of the equity interests in FCH Intermediate Holdings, Inc and FCH Intermediate II Holdings, Inc (together, Flow Control) from FCH Preferred Issuer, L.P., minus rollover interests held by the seller and Flow Control's management as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	24 September 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, Blackstone, is a US-based corporation, incorporated under the laws of Delaware, United States. Blackstone operates as an investment management firm. The target, Flow Control, is a US-based company that manufactures and supplies sanitary flow control solutions for the data centre cooling, food & beverage and pharmaceutical sectors. These products are primarily used to transport and control the flow of liquids in hygiene-sensitive industrial environments. Flow Control's products include stainless steel weldment systems, fittings, tubes, pumps, valves, hoses, single-use assemblies, gaskets, and washdown equipment. Flow Control has no subsidiaries, employees, assets or physical presence in Australia, but makes limited sales of its products to a small number of Australian customers primarily in the food and beverage, and pharmaceutical sectors, through third-party distributors.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). Based on the information provided in the application, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition given there is no horizontal overlap or vertical relationships between Blackstone (and its connected entities) and Flow Control in the supply of valves, fittings, hose assemblies and washdown equipment.

	In these circumstances, the ACCC does not consider it necessary to reach a concluded view on the likelihood of the notification thresholds being met. Given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC's guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
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Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act